

Step 3: Be Specific and Give Evidence

Noise is everywhere, and if you are going to rise above it, you have to alleviate natural consumer skepticism. Do so by being specific, and if possible, offer evidence.

WEB SITE: “Your car sold in 20 days or less or it’s free.”

PRODUCT: “Drop 20 pounds or you don’t pay a dime.”

SERVICE: “Your home sold in 30 days or I own it.”

Domino’s Pizza didn’t say “Delivered on time,” they said, “Delivered within 30 minutes or it’s free.” It was a specific action and evidence of that action. (Your pizza is free if we don’t perform!) In my case, the onus was on me to send my advertisers leads. If I didn’t, I didn’t get paid. “We send you business or you don’t pay a dime.”

Step 4: Keep it Short, Clear, and Concise

The best USPs are short, clear, and powerful. Long phrases get skipped over.

Step 5: Integrate Your USP into ALL Marketing Materials

A USP is worthless if it isn’t conveyed throughout every aspect of your business. Include your USP on all your public communications:

- Your trucks, vehicles, and buildings
- Your advertising and promotional materials
- Business cards, letterheads, signs, brochures, and flyers
- Your Web site and your email signature
- Your voice mail system, receptionist/sales scripts, etc.

Step 6: Make It Real

A USP has to be strong enough to convince people to buy or, even better, switch brands. If it doesn’t capture your audience’s attention, or the benefit/hook is too weak, it won’t work. And then, you have to make your USP real. You must deliver on what you say. A pizza delivered in 40 minutes makes the 30-minute guarantee a fraud. Fraudulent USPs get exposed fast and create “human resource systems” ready to rick-roll your company.

GET NOISY

Next time you’re stuck in traffic, look around. Every car looks the same. Nothing commands any significant attention. It’s a sea of fading exhaustive blather. Born a marketer, this is why I’m preferential to Lamborghinis. They rise above the noise, and so should your brand.